

AS THE BELL TOLLS

Chime Redesign, Repossession Arc & Restoration Consequence Examples

A design-expansion reference grounded in the current Game Design Document and Markdown archive. Proposed mechanics are clearly separated from existing specifications.

Focus: turning time manipulation into the game's signature decision system; making Rupert's Year 3 / Year 4 assessment dramatic without violating the low-pressure life-sim promise; and making all seven restoration stages change lived experience rather than only consume resources.

Status key: "Current specification" reproduces or closely paraphrases what the current Markdown files define. "Proposed example" is new design work for consideration; it is not presented as already implemented.

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Executive Recommendation

The three topics are tightly connected. The best version of the design makes Chimes influence restoration and community life, makes restoration create evidence Rupert can actually observe, and makes Rupert's assessment judge the town by the consequences of the player's choices rather than by a checklist of raw materials.

Recommended design sentence: Chimes let the player decide when Blackmere needs speed, protection, or coordination; restoration converts those choices into visible changes in daily life; Rupert judges whether those changes have made Blackmere capable of sustaining itself.

Core principles

- No Chime should simply mean “less waiting.” Every category should answer a different planning problem.
- Rupert should assess outcomes, not completion percentage. A town can pass through different viable profiles rather than one optimal build.
- Failure should change the campaign, not erase it. The existing GDD explicitly avoids punishing failure states; a repossession branch can create pressure without ending a save.
- Every restoration stage should change at least two layers: visible world state plus NPC/service/routine behavior. Major stages should change three or more.
- Do not build seven entirely separate versions of every scene. Use modular props, lighting, ambient audio, NPC anchors, service flags, crowd density, and schedule deltas to create progression economically.

Recommended restoration verbs by stage

Stage	What the player should feel	Design job
Weathered	“This place is surviving.”	Show damage, workarounds, reduced routines, but still signs of human use.
Rebuilding	“People have started trying again.”	Visible work crews/scaffolds; essential function returns or begins.
Recovering	“Daily life is dependable again.”	Regular schedules return; core service becomes reliable.
Renewed	“This place has its identity back.”	Normal civic/social use resumes; NPCs reference the change.
Growing	“Recovery is creating new possibilities.”	New activities, visitors, choices, or secondary services appear.
Prospering	“Blackmere can plan beyond survival.”	Inter-building synergies, better quality/capacity, richer routines.
Flourishing	“This place now gives something back.”	Signature behavior/perk that affects the wider town, not just the building.

1. Chime Redesign & Implementation

What the current files define

The current Time Manipulation System unlocks when the Manor Central Room reaches Rebuilding. The player begins with 6 Chimes per day and scales to 30 at Flourishing. One Chime currently reduces the remaining duration of an eligible event by a fixed amount based on whether that event lasts hours or days. Eligible examples include animal maturation/byproducts, crops/flowers, and invention crafting/testing.

That implementation is understandable and useful, but it makes the system function mainly as a production accelerator. Because time manipulation is the game's headline differentiator, it should create decisions that ordinary crafting speed-ups cannot.

Three-category model

Category	Player question	Primary fantasy	What it should NOT become
ADVANCE	"What deserves to arrive sooner?"	Give extra time to one process so it reaches its next meaningful state earlier.	A universal skip button that eliminates all waiting.
PRESERVE	"What deserves more time before it is lost or changed?"	Hold a useful, fragile, emotional, or seasonal state in place.	A blanket freeze that removes all consequence or schedule awareness.
SYNCHRONIZE	"What becomes possible if these things happen together?"	Align separate clocks, people, or processes so a better combined outcome can occur.	Tedious micromanagement requiring players to synchronize everything.

Recommended unlock progression

Keep your existing daily Chime capacity progression, but let restoration of the Central Room broaden what time means, not only increase the number of uses.

Central Room	Existing capacity	Proposed capability
Weathered	0	Clock is broken; visual foreshadowing only.
Rebuilding	6	ADVANCE unlocked. One target at a time.
Recovering	8	PRESERVE unlocked. Player can hold one eligible state at once.
Renewed	10	SYNCHRONIZE unlocked for two compatible targets.
Growing	15	"Resonant" effects: a Chime can influence a small linked set where explicitly supported.
Prospering	20	Longer Preserve windows; advanced Sync recipes / community applications.
Flourishing	30	Town-scale ceremonial uses at rare scripted moments; daily use still remains bounded.

ADVANCE - examples that fit Blackmere

Use case	Example
Cultivation	Advance one planted crop/flower to its next growth phase, rather than shaving an abstract number of hours.
Animal care	Move pregnancy/maturation/byproduct readiness toward its next natural milestone; never creates extra animals or duplicate output.
Invention testing	Advance the current test cycle, revealing a result sooner but not guaranteeing quality.
Fabrication queue	Advance one fabricated component so a larger invention can be assembled today.
Restoration crew	Advance one day of a three-day town restoration closure, but only after the player has supplied all materials.

Use case	Example
Preserves / cooking prep	Advance fermentation, steeping, curing, or baking preparation where the recipe already has a time component.
Composting / soil recovery	Advance a depleted plot toward healthy soil condition; useful after intensive growing seasons.
Mail / commissioned work	Advance an explicitly time-gated local commission by one step if both parties are already ready; do not advance global story quests.
Festival preparation	Advance a player-owned preparation task such as curing an entry, testing a Showcase invention, or growing a centerpiece flower.
Repair after weather	Advance cleanup of a storm-damaged player asset without skipping the storm itself.

Key implementation rule: Advance should resolve the next state transition, not reduce every timer by arbitrary seconds. That makes it legible in UI and easier to test in save data.

PRESERVE - examples that fit Blackmere

Use case	Example
Harvest window	Hold a fully grown crop or flower at peak quality for one additional day so the player can prioritize something else.
Fresh food	Suspend spoilage on one pantry stack or prepared communal dish until the next morning. This matters before the Kitchen's Prospering no-spoil unlock.
Animal product	Keep one ready animal byproduct at its best quality if the player cannot collect it immediately.
Weather-dependent forage	Preserve a rare rain/snow forage spawn until the next day after the player discovers it.
Trader opportunity	Mark one Caravan Stall item so it remains in the next inventory refresh; time is preserving the opportunity, not duplicating the item.
Event invitation	Extend a non-critical social invitation window by one day when the player has already earned it. Story-critical events should not require this.
Festival entry	Hold a prepared dish, flower, or invention at showcase quality through the festival date.
Restoration memory	During a memory-linked restoration, preserve an optional environmental trace for later inspection instead of having it disappear immediately.
Workshop stability	Prevent a long invention test from degrading quality during one adverse weather day or power interruption.
Soil condition	Preserve watered/fertilized condition on a small number of plots overnight; useful as a deliberate "I am spending tomorrow elsewhere" choice.

Why Preserve belongs in this game: it directly expresses the GDD's thesis that the player cannot do everything. Instead of giving the player more hours, Preserve lets them protect something they consciously choose not to attend to today.

SYNCHRONIZE - examples that fit Blackmere

Use case	Example
Harvest coordination	Align several already-near-ready crops so they mature together for Harvest Supper or a large cooking plan.
Invention assembly	Synchronize two components with different completion times; when they finish together, assembly receives a reliability or quality bonus.
Animal routine	Align a small group of animals' care/product windows, reducing repeated barn visits for that day without increasing output.
NPC collaboration	For an earned collaborative quest, align the free-time windows of two NPCs so a scene can occur today rather than waiting for their next natural overlap.

Use case	Example
Workshop network	Synchronize Forge + Woodworks + Design Studio commission steps for one civic project, shortening handoff delay while keeping each craft required.
Shared meal	Align oven, stove, and ingredient prep timers so a complex meal completes as one service window, granting a communal meal bonus.
Restoration handoff	Synchronize architect, carpenter, and blacksmith phases on one major restoration, reducing closure without lowering material cost.
Fishing window	Synchronize a short fish activity window with weather/tide conditions already present, increasing encounter consistency but not spawning impossible species.
Festival setup	Synchronize volunteer schedules so the square visibly transforms earlier and NPCs gain extra pre-festival social time.
Bell resonance	Late game: synchronize several town systems to the Bell Tower's hourly toll for a limited "Blackmere in rhythm" civic bonus, such as reduced service delays for one day.

Key implementation rule: Synchronize should be contextual. The UI should only offer valid pairs/sets. The player should never need to hunt through 100 timers to discover whether two things are compatible.

Chime costs and safeguards

Rule	Recommendation
Cost	Advance 1 Chime for ordinary state transitions; Preserve 1-2; Synchronize 2-3 depending on number of targets. Scripted civic uses can cost more.
Daily constraint	Retain the existing daily pool. Do not add a second mana bar.
Target constraint	Each target accepts only one temporal intervention per day unless a late-game invention explicitly changes that.
Story constraint	Chimes should never skip relationship growth, generate Friendship/Connection points, erase a player choice, or auto-complete a main-story objective.
Economy constraint	Chimes accelerate/hold/coordinate production but never duplicate Bellnotes or items.
Readability	Every use previews: effect, Chime cost, resulting state, and whether the effect ends at sleep.
Fail-safe	If a target changes state before an applied Preserve/Sync resolves, refund or gracefully cancel the Chime; never silently consume it.

Reference inspirations - what to borrow, not copy

Reference	Relevant design lesson
The Legend of Zelda: Majora's Mask	Its citizens follow independent, intertwining schedules in a compact time system. The useful lesson for Blackmere is that time becomes emotionally meaningful when NPC routines and opportunities are visible, not just when clocks count down.
The Sexy Brutale	Everything in its mansion occurs simultaneously on a repeating schedule. Useful inspiration for Synchronize: the player understands that events coexist and can intervene at the right overlap.
Braid	Different worlds use different properties of time rather than one rewind gimmick. Useful inspiration for making Advance, Preserve, and Synchronize mechanically distinct.
Life is Strange	Rewind is tied to choices and consequences, not production. Blackmere should keep its gentler tone, but the lesson is that a time power feels important when it changes decisions rather than merely efficiency.
Stardew Valley	Time pressure comes from days, seasons, schedules and multi-day processes, but there is no equivalent targeted time resource. This creates room for Chimes to be distinctive if they interact with those same life-sim rhythms in new ways.

2. Repossession Arc - Rupert's Year 3 / Year 4 Assessment

Why Spring 1, Year 3 works

Spring 1, Year 3 is immediately legible to experienced Stardew Valley players because Grandpa's evaluation occurs at the beginning of Year 3. Using the same calendar beat can create familiarity without copying the evaluation itself. In Blackmere, Rupert is not an approving ancestor judging the player's personal success; he is a government official deciding whether a flood-stricken town is economically and civically viable enough to remain autonomous.

The current main-story file says the town received a “three years to rebuild” notice, while the end-game section begins in Year 4+. Moving Rupert's first formal assessment to Spring 1, Year 3 and giving borderline towns a one-year extension resolves that tension cleanly: the original deadline becomes the first legal review, and the extension creates the Year 4 dramatic deadline only when needed.

Recommended five-pillar assessment

Pillar	What Rupert measures	Examples of evidence
Structural Recovery	Can people safely live and work here?	Essential public buildings out of Weathered; routes/services functioning; Manor able to support player systems.
Economic Viability	Can Blackmere sustain circulation and trade?	Town reserve trend, active shops, trade participation, production diversity, reasonable debt exposure.
Civic Continuity	Does the settlement function as a community rather than scattered survivors?	Town Hall, school/library, festivals/shared meals, Community Board activity, public services.
Community Stability	Are residents choosing to remain and invest in the future?	Relationship breadth, completed resident arcs, active routines, families/children not required but positive evidence.
Future Readiness	Is recovery generating durable capacity?	Blueprint inventions, Grand Showcase performance, infrastructure inventions, restored specialist workshops.

Scoring model - visible categories, hidden arithmetic

I recommend that the player sees a written “Assessment Ledger” with five category ratings - Critical, Fragile, Stable, Strong, Exemplary - but not a raw 0-100 score. Internally, each pillar can score 0-20. This preserves clarity without encouraging spreadsheet optimization.

Outcome	Internal example	Narrative result
Strong Pass	70+ total and no pillar below Stable	Rupert concedes that repossession is not presently justified. Blackmere receives a Continuance Notice and moves into autonomy/endgame pressure rather than survival review.
Pass	60-69 total and at most one Fragile pillar	Blackmere keeps its charter; Rupert schedules routine oversight but no “last chance” deadline.
Conditional Extension	45-59, or a passing total with a Critical essential pillar	Rupert: “You have demonstrated recovery, not sustainability. One year.” Year 4 review is tailored to the weak pillars.
Severe Deficiency	Below 45	Still no immediate save-ending game over. State intervention begins now, creating a harder recovery/appeal branch and a Year 4 final hearing.

Examples of Year 3 passing profiles

Pass profile	What it could look like
Balanced Recovery	At least 8 town buildings at Renewed+, no essential civic building Weathered, town finances positive, 25-35 Blueprint inventions, several Connection arcs underway. No category is spectacular, but all are stable.
Maker's Blackmere	Forge, Woodworks, Design Studio and Hall of Wonder are Renewed/Growing; 45+ inventions; Grand Showcase participation is strong; economy is moderate. Future Readiness offsets only middling residential restoration.
Community First	Town Hall, School, Library, Inn and residences are substantially restored; broad Friendship/Connection progress; festivals and shared meals active. Fewer inventions are acceptable because civic continuity and stability are exceptional.
Trade & Prosperity	Bank, General Store, Caravan, Fishery, Inn and trades are strong; town reserve and commerce are healthy; key infrastructure is safe. Social progression is respectable but not maximized.
Resilient Essentials	Player has restored the functional backbone - Town Hall, Bell Tower, Bank, Store, School, Library, food/trade services - to stable states, even if decorative/optional locations lag. Rupert sees a viable town rather than a complete town.

Recommendation: Do not require every building to reach the same stage. That would turn Rupert into a completion percentage check and force a single optimal restoration order.

A strong Year 3 assessment scene

- Rupert arrives in the morning with a clerk and a formal map similar to the opening map marked with red Xs.
- Instead of one Town Hall conversation, he physically tours 4-6 locations selected from the five pillars. Which places he visits depends on the player's actual save state.
- NPCs are not witnesses the player can “game”; their normal routines and restored spaces are the evidence.
- At each stop, Rupert comments on a concrete consequence: children back in school, stocked shelves, active wharf, functioning workshop, public records, improved trade, etc.
- The final ruling occurs beneath the Bell Tower. The visual condition of Town Square makes the scene itself a summary of progression.

“One last chance” - Year 4 reassessment examples

If Year 3 is conditional, Rupert should issue 2-3 specific covenants based on the save's weak pillars. The Year 4 review then checks whether those exact deficiencies were corrected. This feels fairer and more personal than repeating the same hidden score.

Deficiency at Year 3	Example covenant for Spring 1, Year 4
Structural	Bring Town Hall, School, General Store, and one food source to at least Renewed; no essential service may remain Weathered.
Economic	Maintain a positive town-reserve trend for two seasons; restore three commerce buildings to Renewed+; complete a minimum number of trader transactions or commissions.
Civic	Restore School + Library + Town Hall; complete a season of Community Board requests; ensure at least two communal events operate at their recovered version.
Community	Complete a set number of resident Connection milestones across different households/professions; no requirement to romance anyone.
Future Readiness	Craft a set of civic/utility inventions, place or demonstrate one at the Grand Showcase, and integrate inventions into at least three restored buildings.
Mixed weakness	Rupert chooses one mandatory essential target plus one player-selected target from two categories, preserving agency in the recovery plan.

Success states after the Year 4 review

Success level	Example consequence
Meets conditions	Rupert signs a Charter of Continuance. Repossession notices are removed from doors; the map in Town Hall is physically replaced; NPC dialogue shifts from “if we can keep Blackmere” to “what should Blackmere become?”
Strong recovery	Blackmere receives formal self-governance protections plus renewed trade recognition. New outside visitors/traders can arrive without making outside rescue the reason the town survived.
Exceptional recovery	Rupert is forced to acknowledge Blackmere as a model reconstruction district. The town can choose whether to accept limited state grants, reject them, or negotiate terms - an endgame choice rather than a reward multiplier.

Failure states that do not delete the player's save

The GDD repeatedly says progress should not be erased and imperfect outcomes should not be treated as failure. A literal “government takes Blackmere; game over” would contradict that promise. The better approach is a consequential branch that changes conditions but still gives the community agency.

Failure branch	What changes	Recovery path
State Receivership	A percentage of town commercial revenue is diverted; the bank changes dialogue/terms; Rupert's office posts inspectors at Town Hall.	Restore the weak pillars and build a legal/economic appeal case over Year 4+.
Partial Repossession Orders	One or two non-residential public assets receive closure notices; visual red seals/scaffolds appear. No restored progress is deleted.	Complete targeted restoration/invention projects to prove active use, then petition to lift each order.
Development Contract	The state offers funding but attaches mandatory production targets and cosmetic government signage.	Player may comply temporarily or raise enough local capacity to buy out/terminate the contract.
Community Appeal	Residents collectively challenge Rupert's ruling. Their willingness and evidence depend on relationships and civic restoration.	Turns social progress into legal/political leverage without making friendship a raw score gate.
Blackmere Cooperative	If finances are the failure, residents establish a cooperative fund; personal player wealth cannot simply solve it instantly.	Town businesses contribute based on restoration level; player supports commissions and infrastructure until autonomy is repurchased.

Best-fit recommendation: use State Receivership + Community Appeal as the severe-failure route. It creates a darker Year 4+ arc while preserving every relationship, restoration stage, inventory item and invention the player earned.

Reference inspirations

Reference	Relevant lesson
Stardew Valley - Grandpa's Evaluation	Useful calendar familiarity: the evaluation occurs at Spring 1, Year 3 and scores multiple types of progress. Blackmere should diverge by making the evaluator political, the town the subject, and the outcome materially change the story.
Stardew Valley - Community Center	Room completion repairs the building and unlocks improvements elsewhere in the valley. This is a strong precedent for restoration having functional consequences beyond cosmetics.
My Time at Sandrock	Its core fantasy explicitly combines building/production with saving a town from economic ruin. Blackmere should emphasize governance, community continuity and time stewardship so Rupert's arc does not become only “make the economy bigger.”
Rune Factory: Guardians of Azuma	Rebuilding villages entices people to return and contribute. Useful lesson: a restored place should change population behavior, services and vitality, not only appearance.

Reference	Relevant lesson
Frostpunk	A much harsher genre, but useful as a systems reference: settlement viability is expressed through human conditions as well as resources. For Blackmere, use that lesson gently - services, routines, confidence and continuity are evidence of success.

3. Restoration Consequences - Seven Stages for Every Building & Manor Room

The tables below intentionally show both layers. The Current specification column comes from the existing location Markdown restoration tables. The Proposed visible-life consequence column is new design guidance. These additions are examples, not requirements; the goal is to ensure that every restoration communicates changed life, not merely a resource payment.

Implementation pattern for a solo developer

- Prop layers: 3-6 reusable prop sets per stage (repair debris, functional furniture, decoration, prosperity accents).
- NPC anchors: add or remove a few schedule waypoints per stage rather than authoring entirely new daily routines.
- Ambient population: use small stage-based visitor chances instead of bespoke cutscenes for every upgrade.
- Audio layers: damaged silence -> repair activity -> normal work -> social bustle. Audio can sell progression cheaply.
- Service flags: tie real utility to milestone stages, especially Rebuilding, Renewed, Prospering and Flourishing.
- Cross-location echoes: a Forge restoration can add metal fixtures elsewhere; Tailor progression can improve NPC clothing; School progression can put student work around town. Reuse assets to make the whole town feel connected.

Blackmere Buildings

Blackmere locations currently define appearance progression.

1 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Agatha Whitmore, Beatrice Whitmore, and Roland Whitmore. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Whitmore home remains occupied but repairs are improvised; Agatha/Roland spend more time maintaining it, and Beatrice carries civic work home because shared rooms are unreliable.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	Visible carpentry and laundry lines appear; family schedules temporarily shift around repair work. The player can occasionally help with small household restoration requests.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	Porch seating and a usable garden return. Agatha/Roland begin spending short periods outdoors; Beatrice is more likely to leave civic papers at Town Hall instead of working from home.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	Family meals and evening porch conversations become ambient routine scenes; the house reads as a stable elder/mayoral household rather than a shelter.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	Community visitors begin stopping by for advice; Beatrice may hold occasional informal constituent conversations here, adding life to Resident Lanes.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	Mature garden beds supply flowers/produce to a communal event; household decor reflects three residents rather than generic prosperity.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The home becomes a neighborhood anchor: elders host a small seasonal tea/storytelling gathering, and nearby NPC pathing adds social stops around the property.

2 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Martin Ashcroft. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Martin uses only part of the house; mail sacks/crates are kept indoors because dry storage is scarce, visually blending home and post work.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	Roof and entry are stabilized; temporary parcel shelves appear, and Martin spends less off-hours repairing his own home.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	A dry front room lets Martin sort overflow mail safely; occasional parcel pickup can occur here after postal quests.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	The home becomes clearly personal again, with recovered Ashcroft family objects and evening routines replacing work clutter.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	A small covered delivery nook appears outside; Martin can leave non-critical player mail/overflow here as a convenience unlock.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	Neighbors occasionally use the porch as an informal exchange point, making the postmaster visibly part of community circulation.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The property becomes a recognizable "message hub" of Resident Lanes with seasonal notice ribbons and rare personal letters/notes appearing as environmental storytelling.

3 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Adrian Lockwood and Sabrina Fairchild. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Adrian and Sabrina share cramped usable space; books/school materials are stacked in dry corners, and they often remain at work longer because home is uncomfortable.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	One study area reopens; repair debris reflects the collision of librarian and teacher lives rather than generic construction.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	A reading desk and lesson-prep table become functional; some evening schedules move home, making the lane feel occupied after work hours.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	NPC-specific shelves, teaching supplies and shared decor appear; home dialogue can reference a genuine place of rest.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	A small front reading bench becomes a neighborhood stop for children/adults; Adrian or Sabrina may use it on clear evenings.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	The household occasionally hosts a tiny book/lesson club, linking school and library restoration to residential life.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The home becomes an education-centered social node: rare cross-NPC scenes occur here, and donated/recovered texts visibly cycle through the space.

4 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Irene Calder. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Irene keeps the home sparse and practical, prioritizing Bell Tower duty; damaged clock/bell-related tools sit in the safe room.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	Repairs create a proper work corner for bell records and maintenance tools; Irene spends less time improvising storage.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	Exterior chimes/metalwork return; Irene can occasionally be seen maintaining small mechanisms at home.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	The house gains a calm, precise routine synced to the town bell; lighting/windows make her presence visible at predictable hours.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	A small memorial or historic bell display appears outside after relevant story progress, giving passersby a reason to stop.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	Irene begins mentoring/consulting others on bellkeeping traditions; occasional NPC visits create social motion.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The home becomes a living extension of Blackmere's timekeeping heritage, with special ambient chime details that subtly respond to festival days.

5 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Dante Menici, Madison Remington, and Victor Cross. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Dante, Madison and Victor operate around damaged shared rooms; their different work gear crowds the usable space, making the household feel transitional.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	Repairs split the home into dependable personal/work zones; visible crates, sheriff gear and museum notes move into organized places.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	Evening routines diversify: one resident may host a visitor while others work/rest, giving the shared household more believable life.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	Personalized decor for curator, sheriff and trader makes the home a strong expression of the occupants; home dialogue becomes more specific.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	Victor can occasionally receive a trader contact here, Madison reviews community notices, and Dante catalogs artifacts - three professions visibly intersect.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	Small social dinners or professional meetings occur, tying trade, public safety and museum life together.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The residence becomes a lively crossroad household; rare scenes can seed future trade/artifact/public-safety opportunities without adding a new system.

6 Resident Lane

Current role: Residence for Lucian/Vivian Darrow. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The home shows visible flood damage and years of neglect.	Lucian/Vivian uses the least-damaged corner as a private clockwork bench; ticking parts and salvaged mechanisms dominate the home.
Rebuilding	Repairs strengthen the structure while restoring its comfort.	Repairs stabilize a true workshop nook; the resident spends more evening time here and less at temporary workspaces.
Recovering	Fresh paint, repaired windows, and tidy gardens return warmth.	Finished clocks begin appearing on walls; occasional prototype sounds/lights make the home visually distinct in the lane.
Renewed	The restored home feels cozy, welcoming, and well cared for.	The house becomes an intimate clockmaker residence rather than a generic home; recovered family/rival story props can surface here.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and personal touches give it character.	A small window display or porch mechanism appears, attracting curious NPC stops and reinforcing the town's invention culture.
Prospering	Elegant upgrades and mature gardens reflect a prosperous household.	Lucian/Vivian can perform a rare maintenance service or give a temporal-crafting tip from home after relevant Connection progress.
Flourishing	The beautiful home becomes one of Blackmere's most charming residences.	The residence becomes a "second clockwork landmark": unique hourly animation/ambient response quietly echoes the Manor and Bell Tower without duplicating their functions.

A. Whitmore Public Library

Current role: Location for all Library Books for player to visit and read. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Dusty shelves and damaged books leave the library quiet.	Quiet, damaged shelves restrict circulation; Adrian works around closed sections, and few NPCs linger.
Rebuilding	Shelving and reading areas are carefully restored.	Repair crews open one dependable reading zone; returned books appear in carts and residents briefly visit to see progress.
Recovering	Bright reading rooms and repaired collections reopen to the public.	Normal reading hours resume; children/adults begin scheduled visits, and the donation counter feels integrated into activity.
Renewed	The library feels peaceful, organized, and welcoming.	Reading tables fill at predictable times; restored collections and the Preservation Display Case become visible social/story anchors.
Growing	Decorative reading nooks and gardens encourage visitors to linger.	Reading nooks/garden seating add new hangout anchors; NPCs may recommend books or be found reading outside their usual routines.
Prospering	Expanded collections and refined interiors enrich the experience.	Expanded collection draws visiting scholars/traders during certain events; library research can provide small discovery hints for artifacts/inventions.
Flourishing	The library becomes a treasured sanctuary of knowledge.	The library becomes a town memory institution: rotating displays change with recovered artifacts/books and completed NPC histories, visibly preserving Blackmere's story.

A. Whitmore Public School

Current role: Location for children to be during the day within class. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Aging classrooms and worn playgrounds show years of neglect.	Classes operate in constrained space or abbreviated routines; playground equipment is unusable and children leave promptly.
Rebuilding	Repairs restore classrooms and improve the school grounds.	One classroom and safe path reopen; repair activity becomes part of children's dialogue and daily movement.
Recovering	Bright learning spaces and safe facilities welcome students back.	Full class-day routines resume; children use the grounds before/after class, visibly increasing daytime activity in Resident Lanes.
Renewed	The school feels lively, clean, and full of opportunity.	School events, projects and displays appear; Sabrina's schedule includes preparation and parent/community interactions.
Growing	Decorative gardens and improved play areas enrich the campus.	Garden/play improvements create after-school hangouts and occasional player interactions or mini requests.
Prospering	Expanded classrooms and premium facilities support growing enrollment.	Expanded facilities permit visiting lessons/workshops from tradespeople, connecting professions to children's future aspirations.
Flourishing	The flourishing school becomes a beacon for Blackmere's future.	The school becomes proof of long-term continuity: seasonal student projects visibly decorate other town spaces, and children reference future plans in Blackmere.

Design priority: this is one of the clearest visual proofs that residents believe Blackmere has a future; Rupert should notice it.

Blackmere Bank & Exchange

Current role: Location for bank where the player can take out a loan. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Flood-stained stonework and boarded windows leave the bank looking abandoned.	Elise operates a reduced counter; records are boxed above old water lines and the room feels defensive rather than prosperous.
Rebuilding	Fresh masonry and scaffolding surround ongoing repairs.	Secure counters and ledgers are restored; temporary scaffolding makes the bank visibly active instead of abandoned.
Recovering	Clean stone and repaired windows restore the bank's dignity.	Regular hours and basic loan/exchange services feel reliable; NPCs occasionally conduct transactions.
Renewed	The bank stands polished with restored brass details and neat landscaping.	Clean public desk and repaired vault support civic-finance scenes; town reserve updates can be shown physically on a notice/ledger.
Growing	Decorative planters and refined trim give the bank a welcoming elegance.	New consultation desk lets Elise offer optional financial planning/loan restructuring after relevant progression.
Prospering	Premium stonework and ornate lighting reflect the town's growing wealth.	The bank visibly funds local projects: plaques, loan notices, or NPC conversations connect restored businesses to circulating capital.
Flourishing	The bank serves as a prestigious landmark with immaculate grounds and grand architecture.	The bank becomes a civic confidence marker: prosperity is shown by activity and investment, not piles of money; Rupert's assessment can use it as observable evidence.

Blackmere Bell Tower

Current role: Location for bell to toll at each hour. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	The bell tower is cracked, weathered, and partially silent.	Cracks, missing trim and an unreliable/partial toll make the center of town feel wounded; Irene performs manual checks.
Rebuilding	Damaged stone and the bell mechanism are actively being repaired.	Scaffolding and exposed mechanism animations show active repair; some tolls return but are rough/uneven.
Recovering	The structure is stabilized and the bell rings once again.	Hourly toll is dependable again; NPC schedules can visibly react to it with small transitions at key hours.
Renewed	The restored tower proudly overlooks the town with renewed strength.	The square reorients around the restored tower; festivals use it confidently and residents reference hearing the bell across town.
Growing	Decorative banners and landscaping brighten the historic landmark.	Banners/planters plus scheduled gathering moments make the tower a social anchor, not scenery.
Prospering	Elegant stonework and lighting make it a centerpiece of the square.	Evening lighting and refined chime patterns change the square ambience; special festival peals become distinct.
Flourishing	The magnificent bell tower becomes the iconic symbol of Blackmere.	The tower becomes Blackmere's systemic rhythm: rare Synchronize Chime interactions can use its toll as a town-wide anchor, while NPCs pause/respond during signature bells.

Design priority: make the bell more than ambience. Small NPC reactions and late-game Synchronize resonance can make it the town's shared clock.

Blackmere General Store

Current role: Location for player to shop for general goods (flower seeds, foraged items, and ore). Residence for Walter Pierce. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Weathered walls and empty shelves reflect difficult times.	Walter has sparse shelves and inconsistent stock; residents enter for essentials but rarely browse.
Rebuilding	Repairs restore the storefront while supplies slowly return.	Repaired storefront and deliveries create visible restocking activity; some shelves remain intentionally bare.
Recovering	Fresh paint and stocked shelves welcome customers again.	Core stock is dependable; NPC shoppers appear on schedules and Walter can discuss which goods are returning.
Renewed	The fully restored shop feels warm, bright, and inviting.	The shop feels warm and lived-in; displays respond to season and local production instead of generic inventory rows.
Growing	Decorative displays and flower boxes give the store extra charm.	Local-producer shelf appears, featuring goods tied to restored farms/trades and giving the player a new sale/consignment outlet if desired.
Prospering	Expanded displays and premium decor create a thriving marketplace.	Expanded displays and customer traffic make commerce visibly healthy; occasional bulk/community orders create requests.
Flourishing	The bustling general store becomes the heart of daily commerce.	The store becomes daily commerce hub: seasonal window displays, NPC shopping conversations, and town-produced stock visually prove Blackmere's self-sufficiency.

Blackmere Town Hall

Current role: Location for the Community Board for the player to complete daily quests. Location for the player's Public Mailbox for the player to view their mail outside of the manor. Location for the wedding between the player and their betrothed NPC. Location for the Marriage Records for the player to be able to apply for a divorce. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Cracked stone and faded banners leave the town hall neglected.	Only essential offices are usable; notices overlap on damaged boards and civic business feels improvised.
Rebuilding	Structural repairs and fresh stonework restore its foundation.	Repaired public counter and records area allow visible municipal work; Community Board remains modest.
Recovering	New windows and cleaned walls return civic pride.	Regular civic hours and organized notices return; NPCs occasionally enter for permits/meetings/mail.
Renewed	The town hall stands fully restored with polished architecture.	Weddings, records and Community Board activity feel like normal public life; restored banners reflect town identity.
Growing	Decorative landscaping and banners celebrate Blackmere's recovery.	Council/community meeting nights create new NPC congregation; player can see restoration priorities or town initiatives discussed.
Prospering	Elegant stone accents and vibrant gardens elevate its appearance.	Town Hall displays completed civic projects and hosts visiting delegations/traders, tying progress to governance.
Flourishing	The grand town hall symbolizes the town's complete renewal.	Town Hall becomes the visible seat of autonomy: after repossession success, state notices are removed/replaced with Blackmere's charter and resident-driven planning boards.

Design priority: use this building to surface the repossession arc physically through notices, maps, meetings and eventually the town charter.

Caravan Stall

Current role: Location for player to shop for random goods. All goods sold are 18 random items, no matter the season. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	A worn canopy and sparse goods reflect struggling trade.	The stall is a rough temporary pitch; limited shelter means the traders pack quickly and few locals linger.
Rebuilding	A sturdier stall and new stock slowly return.	Level ground, tie-downs and a repaired awning create a dependable stopping point; setup/teardown becomes visible.
Recovering	Bright displays and organized merchandise attract customers again.	Locals begin browsing alongside the player; the stall feels like recurring trade rather than a secret vendor.
Renewed	The restored stall feels colorful, welcoming, and well-stocked.	Seating/signage and secure storage make the visit a recognizable town routine; trader dialogue can reference Blackmere's improvements.
Growing	Decorative banners and upgraded displays enhance its charm.	Local producers can occasionally place one export good at the stall, connecting town restoration to outside demand.
Prospering	Premium goods and expanded displays draw shoppers from afar.	Trade visits attract small clusters and specialty requests; inventory can include more Blackmere-linked exchange opportunities without simply adding more random slots.
Flourishing	The bustling market stall becomes one of the town's favorite attractions.	The stall becomes a genuine exchange point between Blackmere and the outside world, with rotating flags/crates/visitors showing the town has reentered regional trade.

Hall of Wonder

Current role: Location for player to donate gemstones and artifacts to the museum. Located in Resident Lanes District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Dusty exhibits and damaged displays leave the museum forgotten.	Damaged cases and closed wings make donations feel like rescue/storage; Dante focuses on preservation.
Rebuilding	Galleries undergo repairs while exhibits are carefully restored.	One gallery reopens while restoration is visibly underway; donated artifacts begin appearing in protected displays.
Recovering	Restored halls begin welcoming visitors again.	Regular visitors return; each completed collection section visibly changes the interior and NPC visitation.
Renewed	The museum proudly showcases its collections in pristine condition.	The museum becomes a destination; school/library routines can include visits and Dante gains public-facing activities.
Growing	New displays and decorative lighting enrich every exhibit.	Rotating themed exhibits or gemstone demonstrations create seasonal reasons to revisit beyond donation completion.
Prospering	Expanded galleries celebrate Blackmere's history and discoveries.	Outside scholars/traders occasionally visit, enabling artifact lore, appraisal, or special requests.
Flourishing	The museum becomes a renowned cultural destination filled with wonder.	The Hall becomes Blackmere's proof that the town has a past worth preserving and a future worth visiting; completed collections can influence Rupert/civic pride scenes.

Ironveil Forge

Current role: Location for player to upgrade tools. Residence for Marcus Rowan. Located in Trades Quarter District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Rusted equipment and soot-covered walls reveal years of neglect.	Marcus works with patched equipment and limited safe stations; sparks/sound are intermittent and upgrades feel laborious.
Rebuilding	New stonework and repaired furnaces bring the forge back to life.	Core forge and roof/ventilation are repaired; visible fabrication orders stack up as work returns.
Recovering	The forge operates again with restored equipment and tidy workspaces.	Regular hammering and NPC tool pickups show the forge serving the town, not only the player.
Renewed	Bright fires and polished tools fill the fully restored workshop.	Upgrade service becomes visually efficient; finished tools/components appear in racks tied to actual progression.
Growing	Decorative ironwork and expanded workstations enhance the forge.	An apprentice/demo area or commissioned civic components bring other NPCs into the forge at scheduled times.
Prospering	Premium equipment and ornate craftsmanship showcase master smithing.	Forge contributes specialized parts to town projects; restored buildings may show Marcus-made fixtures, creating cross-location continuity.
Flourishing	The forge stands as one of the finest workshops in the region.	The forge becomes a regional craft landmark: masterwork commissions and Grand Showcase preparation make it a living source of Blackmere's technical reputation.

Klein Woodworks

Current role: Location for player to shop for fabricated items. Residence for Mara Klein. Located in Town Square District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Damaged beams and broken lumber piles clutter the workshop.	Mara works around warped lumber and limited dry storage; orders are few and the shop is dominated by repair triage.
Rebuilding	Fresh timber repairs strengthen the aging building.	Sawing/beam stations return; stacked restoration orders visually communicate Blackmere's rebuilding phase.
Recovering	Organized work areas and repaired walls restore production.	NPC deliveries/pickups and steady machinery show construction becoming organized; fabrication stock is dependable.
Renewed	The workshop feels warm, sturdy, and beautifully handcrafted.	Workshop walls display completed local projects and personal artifacts from Mara's arc, making success communal.
Growing	Decorative carvings and tidy lumber yards reflect growing success.	Community workshop sessions or small custom-furniture jobs add social activity and player-facing customization hooks.
Prospering	Expanded facilities and elegant woodworking displays impress visitors.	Woodworks supplies decorative/structural upgrades across town; recognizable designs appear on restored properties.
Flourishing	The workshop becomes a showcase of exceptional craftsmanship.	The shop becomes a craft commons where residents occasionally build/repair together; it visually demonstrates that Blackmere now maintains itself rather than waiting for the player.

Rain & Hale

Current role: Location for player to create tonics with the Tonic Kit and to shop for Herbs. Residence for Julian Hale. Located in Gloamwood Forest.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Broken windows and faded signage leave the clinic unwelcoming.	Julian works with salvaged shelving and limited drying space; herb bundles dominate every safe surface.
Rebuilding	Repairs restore the building while medical supplies slowly return.	Repaired hut and drying racks improve organization; patient/customer visits remain sparse but visible.
Recovering	Bright interiors and repaired rooms improve patient care.	Normal tonic/herb service returns; NPCs occasionally collect remedies and seasonal herb stock is displayed.
Renewed	The restored clinic feels clean, safe, and comforting.	The apothecary feels calm and dependable; treatment/preparation scenes support Julian's identity beyond being a shop.
Growing	Decorative gardens and updated furnishings create a calming atmosphere.	A small teaching/herb-garden area enables tonic demonstrations or gathering hints tied to weather/season.
Prospering	Expanded treatment rooms and refined decor improve every visit.	Improved storage and equipment allow rare community-preparation events before storms/winter/festivals.
Flourishing	The clinic stands as a beautiful symbol of health and hope.	Rain & Hale becomes a health-and-knowledge node: cultivated herb beds, visiting residents and shared remedies visibly show Blackmere can care for its people.

Riverbend Fishery

Current role: Location for player to shop for fishing nets. Residence for Elise Moreau and Nora Reed. Located in River Wharf District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Worn docks and damaged nets show years of hardship.	Nora/Elise operate around damaged planks and sparse gear; boats/nets look patched and wharf traffic is minimal.
Rebuilding	Piers and fishing equipment are steadily repaired.	Safe working platforms and net racks return; repair animations make recovery obvious.
Recovering	Restored docks and fresh nets return the fishery to operation.	Regular fishery hours and fish handling resume; NPC buyers and catches make the wharf feel productive.
Renewed	The fishery feels lively with sturdy docks and clean buildings.	Dependable shop/service plus ambient sorting/cleaning activity establish a real working waterfront.
Growing	Decorative barrels, flowers, and fresh paint add waterfront charm.	Smoke/drying or community fish-prep area (if compatible with economy design) creates additional routines and seasonal events.
Prospering	Expanded docks and premium equipment support a thriving business.	Restored cold/storage infrastructure increases trade reliability; more crates leave for town/traders rather than increasing fish spawn magically.
Flourishing	The vibrant fishery becomes Blackmere's proud riverside centerpiece.	The fishery becomes the visible livelihood of River Wharf, supporting breakfast/inn/trade routines and signaling that the river is once again sustaining rather than only threatening Blackmere.

Thread & Thimble

Current role: Location for player to shop for clothing and alter their appearance and clothes. Residence for Leo Finch. Located in Trades Quarter District. All clothing items sold are 8 random items, no matter the season.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Weathered fabric displays and faded paint dull the boutique.	Leo sells from limited racks; most clothes around town remain patched and mended, matching the early visual identity.
Rebuilding	Repairs restore the storefront and sewing rooms.	Repaired sewing floor and fitting area allow visible commissions; fabric scraps and mending orders show active work.
Recovering	Fresh decor and organized displays welcome shoppers again.	Regular clothing selection and appearance service return; NPC outfits can begin receiving subtle repaired/seasonal variants.
Renewed	The tailor shop feels elegant, colorful, and inviting.	The shop becomes expressive rather than merely functional; window displays rotate and townspeople browse.
Growing	Decorative awnings and floral displays enhance its charm.	Custom-dye/alteration or small style requests create player/NPC expression moments without multiplying full clothing systems.
Prospering	Luxurious fabrics and stylish storefront displays attract visitors.	Prosperity is reflected town-wide through better-maintained seasonal clothing; Leo's work becomes visible on NPCs, not only in shop inventory.
Flourishing	The boutique becomes Blackmere's premier destination for fashion.	The tailor becomes a cultural marker: festival garments, wedding attire and signature Blackmere styles show that residents now have room for beauty as well as survival.

Weiss Design Studio

Current role: Location for player to craft items and inventions using the Workbench. Residence for Clara Weiss. Located in Trades Quarter District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Cracked walls and faded sketches leave the studio uninspiring.	Clara drafts around damaged tables and salvaged plans; models are incomplete and civic work is reactive.
Rebuilding	Structural repairs create a solid foundation for new ideas.	Stable drafting stations return; active restoration blueprints visibly fill the studio.
Recovering	Bright interiors and restored workspaces inspire creativity again.	Normal workbench/invention collaboration feels organized; NPC clients/contractors occasionally visit.
Renewed	The studio feels modern, organized, and beautifully designed.	Completed models/maps show restored districts; the studio becomes a visual record of what the player has changed.
Growing	Decorative models and landscaping showcase architectural talent.	Planning sessions allow optional choices between cosmetic/function variants for selected civic projects where scope permits.
Prospering	Expanded drafting rooms and refined finishes elevate the workspace.	Clara coordinates multi-shop projects; Forge/Woodworks handoffs are reflected through NPC visits and staged components.
Flourishing	The studio becomes a celebrated center of architectural excellence.	The studio becomes Blackmere's future-planning room: post-repossession boards show new projects chosen for growth rather than emergency repair.

Winding Banks Inn

Current role: Location for player to shop for meals and drinks as well as rest and recover stamina. When renting a room, the duration is for 2 hours and it refills 50 points of stamina. Players are only able to rent a room before 9:00pm. Residence for Felix Holt, Frederick Holt, Helen Holt, and Theo Bennett. Located in River Wharf District.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Weathered walls and worn furnishings make the inn feel tired.	Only part of the inn feels comfortable; guest traffic is low, meals are pragmatic, and the family handles constant repairs.
Rebuilding	Guest rooms and common areas undergo extensive repairs.	Guest rooms/common area repair brings visible workers and a few returning travelers; breakfast tables stop feeling empty.
Recovering	Cozy interiors and repaired rooms welcome travelers once more.	Regular visitors stay again; dining and room-rental routines gain NPC traffic, and the weekly breakfast grows.
Renewed	The restored inn feels warm, comfortable, and bustling.	The inn becomes a warm gathering place; recurring meals and evening conversations make River Wharf socially alive.
Growing	Decorative gardens and inviting outdoor seating add character.	Outdoor seating/garden creates new hangout anchors; travelers can bring rumors, requests or regional flavor.
Prospering	Elegant furnishings and expanded amenities attract more guests.	Expanded amenities and steady guests tie the inn to trade and festivals; performers/special visitors may appear occasionally.
Flourishing	The flourishing inn becomes Blackmere's most beloved gathering place.	The inn becomes Blackmere's social crossroads: locals and outsiders mix, shared meals visibly scale, and returning guests recognize the town's recovery.

Pendrelle Manor Rooms & Grounds

Manor locations currently define functional unlocks/capacity progression. The proposed column adds lived-space behavior so numerical unlocks are visible in the world.

Barn

Current role: Holds all Barn animals (Cow, Goat, Pig, and Sheep) Barn animals can start being purchased at the Rebuilding stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Collapsed/unsafe stalls remain empty; exterior shows evidence that livestock life has not yet returned.
Rebuilding	2 Max Barn Animals	Two animals can live safely; feed/water stations and morning animal sounds return, making the estate feel inhabited.
Recovering	4 Max Barn Animals	More stalls support a mixed small herd; animals have distinct resting/feeding anchors rather than standing as capacity units.
Renewed	6 Max Barn Animals	Routine animal-care flow becomes efficient and visually clean; manure/feed storage and NPC animal visits can appear.
Growing	8 Max Barn Animals	Expanded herd creates visible pasture/yard activity and occasional breeding/young-animal scenes if that system exists.
Prospering	10 Max Barn Animals	Barn products feed cooking/trade/community requests more visibly; Edward or spouse/family may occasionally interact with animals.
Flourishing	15 Max Barn Animals	Fifteen-animal capacity should culminate in a lived agricultural center: varied idle behavior, organized storage, seasonal decor, and a signature husbandry perk/invention synergy rather than capacity alone.

Butler Quarters

Current role: Living quarters for Edward. Butler Help is available starting at the Weathered stage (Edward will give tips on what to do next or aid on a quest). Daily Advice is available starting at the Rebuilding stage (Edward gives a tip or advice at the start of the day). Weather Forecast is available starting at the Recovering stage (Calendar will feature a weather forecast for the next 3 days). Manor Report is available starting at the Renewed stage (Animals and crops will have informational panels available to show growth details). Lost & Found is available starting at the Growing stage (Edward will gift the player a different nonfood ingredient item at the start of each day). Groundskeeper is available starting at the Prospering stage (Edward will harvest any ready crop or flower, placing them in the Pantry or Storage Chest). Butler Tunnels are available starting at the Flourishing stage (Edward unlocks fasttravel locations across Blackmere).

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Butler Help	Edward has a serviceable but austere room; Butler Help is framed as personal knowledge, not an upgraded system.
Rebuilding	Daily Advice	Daily Advice is accompanied by a morning desk/map routine; room gains organized notes tied to player priorities.
Recovering	Weather Forecast	Weather Forecast appears as instruments/charts in the room; Edward visibly checks them before giving forecasts.
Renewed	Manor Report	Manor Report is represented by ledgers/boards Edward updates, making informational UI feel diegetic.
Growing	Lost & Found	Lost & Found uses a visible recovered-items shelf; gifts feel like things Edward actually found while maintaining the estate.
Prospering	Groundskeeper	Groundskeeper unlock is shown by tools/baskets and Edward's schedule changing to include garden/orchard work.
Flourishing	Butler Tunnels	Butler Tunnels should visibly reopen hidden service doors/maps; fast travel is the culmination of Edward restoring how the manor once functioned, not a menu perk appearing from nowhere.

Central Room

Current role: Holds the Grandfather Clock Time Manipulation is available starting at the Rebuilding stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	The broken grandfather clock is a focal wound in the house; no Chimes, irregular ticks or silence.
Rebuilding	Time Manipulation / 6 Chimes	Clock runs again; ADVANCE and 6 Chimes introduce targeted intervention with obvious clock-face feedback.
Recovering	8 Chimes	Clock case/pendulum stabilizes; PRESERVE unlock is represented by a second ring/hand that can “hold” a state.
Renewed	10 Chimes	Full face mechanism returns; SYNCHRONIZE unlock uses paired hands/markers to align two processes.
Growing	15 Chimes	Room becomes a planning hub with visible time-linked project markers; Chime capacity increase feels like mastery, not only a larger bar.
Prospering	20 Chimes	Clock interfaces with key manor/town inventions; advanced temporal effects visibly resonate through nearby mechanisms.
Flourishing	30 Chimes	At Flourishing, the clock is Myrtle's legacy made whole: 30 Chimes plus rare civic resonance uses. The room should host story/family/community scenes so the mechanical heart is also the emotional heart.

Design priority: this should receive more bespoke stage treatment than almost any other room because it carries the game's core mechanic and Myrtle's legacy.

Coop

Current role: Holds all Coop animals (Chicken, Duck, and Goose) Coop animals can start being purchased at the Rebuilding stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Unsafe nesting space remains empty and quiet.
Rebuilding	2 Max Coop Animals	Two birds return; eggs/nests and small morning routines make the yard lively.
Recovering	4 Max Coop Animals	Mixed flock support increases; ducks/geese/chickens use differentiated areas where possible.
Renewed	6 Max Coop Animals	Clean nesting/feeding flow makes byproduct collection visually understandable and less cluttered.
Growing	8 Max Coop Animals	Expanded flock adds yard social behavior and seasonal touches; family/NPCs may stop to watch/feed birds.
Prospering	10 Max Coop Animals	Coop products visibly enter kitchen/market loops; quality storage or invention synergy is represented physically.
Flourishing	15 Max Coop Animals	Fifteen-bird capacity culminates in a bustling but orderly coop with species-specific behaviors and a signature flock-management convenience beyond the number cap.

Dining Hall

Current role: Hosts the Toll of Hearths festival on Day 25 of Winter. Guests are available starting at the Rebuilding stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Large room is mostly closed/off-limits; furniture is covered and the scale of past gatherings is obvious.
Rebuilding	9 Max Guests	Nine guests can be hosted; first table/lighting returns and small dinners become possible.
Recovering	12 Max Guests	Twelve guests fill more of the room; NPC seating patterns and meal ambience make gatherings feel social rather than a cutscene backdrop.
Renewed	15 Max Guests	Fifteen guests allow meaningful community dinners and relationship scenes; decorations reflect season/events.
Growing	18 Max Guests	Eighteen guests support rotating themed meals or visiting groups; guest composition can react to relationships and town progress.
Prospering	24 Max Guests	Twenty-four guests make the hall a genuine civic venue; pre/post festival setup activity appears.
Flourishing	All Guests	All guests culminates in Toll of Hearths at full scale, plus occasional late-game communal meals that show the Manor has become a shared home for Blackmere rather than private luxury.

Garden

Current role: Holds soil squares for growing Garden crops and flowers. Planting and harvesting crops and flowers is available starting at the Rebuilding stage. Greenhouse effect with roof is available starting at the Prospering stage (ability to plant crops or flowers from any season).

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Mud, debris and unusable beds show what the flood did; wild volunteer plants can hint at future fertility.
Rebuilding	Farming / 9 Soil Squares	Nine usable squares open with clear paths and simple tools; planting visibly returns life to the estate.
Recovering	12 Soil Squares	Twelve squares plus repaired edging/irrigation cues; more pollinators/ambient activity appear as planted diversity increases.
Renewed	15 Soil Squares	Fifteen squares feel like a maintained garden; NPC/spouse may visit, sit, or comment on seasonal blooms.
Growing	18 Soil Squares	Eighteen squares support decorative/cooking/flower zones and optional garden layout expression.
Prospering	Greenhouse Effect / 24 Soil Squares	Greenhouse effect + 24 squares gets a visible roof/glass transformation; off-season plants become a striking proof of invention/restoration synergy.
Flourishing	30 Soil Squares	Thirty squares should feel like an estate garden in full life: strong pollinator ambience, family/NPC use, and perhaps a limited communal donation/flower-cutting perk rather than only six more plots.

Kitchen

Current role: Holds the Pantry, Stove, and Blender for storing food and cooking. Pantry is available starting at the Weathered stage. Stove and Blender are available starting at the Rebuilding stage. Food and ingredients no longer spoil starting at the Prospering stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Pantry / 16 Storage Slots	Pantry works but cooking space is damaged; storage is survival-oriented and visibly limited.
Rebuilding	Stove / Blender / 32 Storage Slots	Stove/blender restore the smell/sound of cooking; 32 slots plus first cooked meals make the Manor feel habitable.
Recovering	48 Storage Slots	48 slots are represented by repaired shelving/cold storage; Edward/spouse can plausibly use the room in routines.
Renewed	64 Storage Slots	64 slots plus complete preparation surfaces support shared cooking scenes and recipe progression.
Growing	80 Storage Slots	80 slots should add workflow/life, not just shelving: ingredient baskets, preserves, family meal prep, or recipe-display props.
Prospering	No Spoiled Food / 96 Storage Slots	No-spoil + 96 slots needs a visible invention/cold-cellar explanation; this is a major functional restoration and should alter shopping/harvest planning.
Flourishing	112 Storage Slots	112 slots culminates in a communal kitchen: helpers/guests may use it during major meals, and the room visually feeds the Dining Hall/festival ecosystem.

Laboratory

Current role: Holds the Workbench and Tonic Kit for crafting items and inventions as well as crafting tonics. Also holds the Storage Chest for storing nonfood items. Storage Chest is available starting at the Weathered stage. Workbench is available starting at the Rebuilding stage. Tonic Kit is available starting at the Renewed stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Storage Chest / 16 Storage Slots	Storage Chest occupies the only safe space; Myrtle's old work area is damaged and inaccessible.
Rebuilding	Workbench / 32 Storage Slots	Workbench returns; active prototypes, tools and failed parts make invention feel physical.
Recovering	48 Storage Slots	48 storage plus repaired benches allow multiple project types to be visually staged; rival/quest collaborators can visit.
Renewed	Tonic Kit / 64 Storage Slots	Tonic Kit unlock creates a second craft identity; herb apparatus and clockwork fabrication coexist.
Growing	80 Storage Slots	80 slots should be accompanied by test rigs/display shelves that show previously built inventions, making progression persistent in the room.
Prospering	96 Storage Slots	96 slots plus advanced infrastructure allows synchronized multi-part testing or quality diagnostics, tying into Chime redesign.
Flourishing	112 Storage Slots	112 slots culminates in a true invention laboratory: completed Blueprint milestones visibly fill the space, collaborators visit, and a signature late-game test function reduces friction without automating crafting.

Main Bedroom

Current role: Contains the bed and dresser of the player, where they go to sleep at night and can change their clothes and appearance. Bed and Dresser are available starting at the Weathered stage. Consumer Bin is available starting at the Rebuilding stage. Dogs and Cats are available for purchase starting at the Recovering stage. Player stamina also increases with each restoration stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	Bed / Dresser / 100 Max Stamina	Bed/dresser are usable but the room feels temporary; the player is sleeping in inherited ruins, not yet living in a home.
Rebuilding	Consumer Bin / 120 Max Stamina	Consumer Bin + 120 stamina coincides with warmer lighting, repaired personal storage and the first sense of ownership.
Recovering	1 Max Dog / 1 Max Cat / 140 Max Stamina	Pets unlock + 140 stamina; pet beds/bowls and animal movement immediately change the emotional life of the room.
Renewed	1 Max Dog / 1 Max Cat / 160 Max Stamina	160 stamina should add personal-display/customization anchors so the room reflects the player's history, clothing and relationship state.
Growing	2 Max Dogs / 2 Max Cats / 180 Max Stamina	Two dogs/cats + 180 stamina can add spouse/pet routines and morning/evening ambient scenes if married.
Prospering	2 Max Dogs / 2 Max Cats / 200 Max Stamina	200 stamina is represented by comfort rather than luxury alone - better bed, insulation, quiet, and a stronger "well rested" home feeling.
Flourishing	3 Max Dogs / 3 Max Cats / 220 Max Stamina	220 stamina + three pets should culminate in the player being visibly rooted: family photos/keepsakes, pet routines, spouse/child traces, and a morning reflection bonus or cosmetic ritual rather than another inventory function.

Nursery

Current role: Holds any children that the player and their spouse have. Children are available to have and live in the Nursery starting at the Recovering stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Room is damaged/unused, perhaps holding covered furniture that foreshadows a future the player has not chosen.
Rebuilding	n/a	Rebuilding makes the room safe but deliberately neutral; no pressure to have children. It can temporarily serve as storage/display space.
Recovering	1 Max Child	One child capacity brings age-appropriate furniture and first family routines only if the player actually has a child; otherwise it remains an optional prepared room.
Renewed	1 Max Child	One-child Renewed stage improves play/sleep space and adds child-specific environmental storytelling rather than capacity.
Growing	2 Max Children	Two-child capacity adds shared play anchors and sibling/family routines if relevant; otherwise cosmetic room options can fill the space.
Prospering	3 Max Children	Three-child capacity should improve family utility - toy storage, reading nook, caregiver routines - not simply add beds.
Flourishing	4 Max Children	Four-child Flourishing stage is a fully lived family wing when used; for child-free saves, offer an alternate "Legacy Room" use so Flourishing never requires parenthood.

Design priority: do not make parenthood mandatory for full Manor restoration. A child-free alternate Flourishing use avoids turning a life choice into a completion tax.

Orchard

Current role: Holds soil squares for growing Orchard crops. Planting and harvesting crops is available starting at the Rebuilding stage. Greenhouse effect with roof is available starting at the Prospering stage (ability to plant crops from any season).

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Flood-damaged ground and dead/tilted trees show long recovery horizons.
Rebuilding	Farming / 6 Soil Squares	Six plots/trees can be planted; early saplings make time investment visually obvious.
Recovering	9 Soil Squares	Nine plots and repaired paths support a recognizable orchard routine; blossoms/fruit attract ambient wildlife.
Renewed	12 Soil Squares	Twelve plots create shaded walkways and harvest activity; spouse/NPCs may stroll or help during fruit season.
Growing	15 Soil Squares	Fifteen plots allow cultivar zones, beehive/pollinator synergies or picnic anchors if those systems fit.
Prospering	Greenhouse Effect / 18 Soil Squares	Greenhouse effect + 18 plots needs visible glass/windbreak/invention logic; off-season fruit becomes a prestigious achievement.
Flourishing	24 Soil Squares	Twenty-four plots culminate in a mature estate orchard used for harvest gatherings, cooking supply and scenic social moments - the space should feel older and richer each year.

Stables

Current role: Holds all Stables animals (Horse) Horses can start being purchased at the Rebuilding stage.

Stage	Current specification	Proposed visible-life consequence
Weathered	n/a	Empty, damaged stalls emphasize lost mobility and estate decline.
Rebuilding	1 Max Horse	One horse returns, changing traversal immediately; grooming/tack props make ownership visible.
Recovering	1 Max Horse	Same one-horse capacity but better stable condition should improve life: shelter, grooming interaction, horse comfort animation or reduced care friction.
Renewed	1 Max Horse	Still one horse; Renewed should add a meaningful stable function such as saddle/loadout storage or a named horse bond milestone rather than no mechanical change.
Growing	2 Max Horses	Two horses permit choice between mounts or household use; spouse/NPC stable visits can appear.
Prospering	2 Max Horses	Two horses plus improved tack/storage can support travel convenience or mounted inventory, if scope allows.
Flourishing	3 Max Horses	Three horses culminates in a small working stable with distinct stalls and travel identity; a signature route/ride perk is more meaningful than capacity alone.

Design priority: Recovering and Renewed currently retain the same one-horse capacity. Those stages need qualitative benefits so they do not feel empty.

4. Recommended Priority Order

These changes do not need to be implemented all at once. The following order gives the highest design value per production cost.

Priority	Work	Why first
1	Prototype Advance / Preserve / Synchronize on 6-8 targets.	Proves whether Chimes are genuinely fun before content multiplies.
2	Define Rupert's five pillars and Year 3 thresholds in data.	Makes the story deadline compatible with player freedom and gives restoration measurable purpose.
3	Add visible-life rules to Town Hall, Bell Tower, School, General Store, Inn, Forge and Central Room.	These locations can demonstrate the entire restoration philosophy in a vertical slice.
4	Create reusable restoration-state components for props, NPC anchors, ambience and service flags.	Prevents 33 locations x 7 states from becoming 231 bespoke scene builds.
5	Add targeted Year 4 covenants generated from weak Year 3 pillars.	Turns "failure" into a personalized continuation rather than a generic punishment.
6	Roll the same restoration consequence template through residences and remaining Manor rooms.	Content scales after the underlying system is proven.

One vertical-slice test

A strong test slice would include: Central Room at Rebuilding/Recovering/Renewed; Town Hall across Weathered -> Renewed; one residence; General Store; School; one three-day restoration closure; and a mock Rupert inspection using those locations. If players can explain the difference between Advance, Preserve and Synchronize after one session - and can describe how restored spaces changed NPC life without opening the restoration menu - the redesign is doing its job.

Sources & Inspirations

Primary project sources: current Game Design Document and the August 2026 Markdown archive, especially Systems/TimeManipulationSystem.md, Systems/RestorationSystem.md, Progression/MainStoryProgression.md, Characters/Politicians/RupertMunro.md, and all Locations/Blackmere + Locations/Pendrelle Manor files.

Source	URL	Why referenced
Stardew Valley Wiki - Grandpa	https://wiki.stardewvalley.net/Grandpa	Spring 1, Year 3 evaluation; multi-factor scoring; reevaluation remains possible.
Stardew Valley Wiki - Bundles / Community Center	https://wiki.stardewvalley.net/Bundles	Restored rooms create rewards and improvements beyond cosmetics.
Nintendo - Majora's Mask 3D	https://www.nintendo.com/au/games/nintendo-3ds/the-legend-of-zelda-majoras-mask-3d/	Citizens follow independent intertwining paths; time control is central to understanding their schedules.
Steam - The Sexy Brutale	https://store.steampowered.com/app/552590/The_Sexy_Brutale/	Simultaneous scheduled events in a repeating day; useful conceptual reference for Synchronize.
Nintendo - Braid, Anniversary Edition	https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/braid-anniversary-edition-nintendo-switch-2-edition-switch-2/	Rewind, pause and different time properties are used as distinct puzzle verbs.
Life is Strange manual	https://www.feralinteractive.com/en/manuals/lifeisstrange/latest/steam/	Time rewind changes choices/actions and carries narrative consequences.
Steam - My Time at Sandrock	https://store.steampowered.com/app/1084600/My_Time_at_Sandrock/	Builder fantasy explicitly connects production and community restoration to saving a town from economic ruin.
Steam - Rune Factory: Guardians of Azuma	https://store.steampowered.com/app/2864560/Rune_Factory_Guardians_of_Azuma/	Village rebuilding draws people back and makes them contribute to restored settlements.

External references are used as design inspirations only. Proposed mechanics in this document are original recommendations for As The Bell Tolls and are not claims about features already present in the project.